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Benefits
Hub

› Texas ›

Low-Income
Home
Energy
Assistance
Program
(LIHEAP) in
Texas

**Low-
Income
Home**



Energy Assistance Program (LIHEAP) in Texas

Get \$1,000–
\$12,600 paid
directly to your
loved one's utility
company to cover
heating and

cooling bills.

Estimated savings:

\$1,000 – \$12,600/year

in 2026 (Texas

Department of

Housing and

Community Affairs

CEAP guidelines)



Reviewed by

Dr. Logan DuBose

Overview

Eligibility

How

If your loved one

If your loved one struggles to pay electric, gas, or propane bills on a fixed income, LIHEAP provides direct payments to utility companies. In Texas, this program is delivered through CEAP (Comprehensive Energy Assistance Program) and covers one-time payments of \$1,000 to \$12,600 for regular

heating and cooling assistance, plus up to \$2,400 in crisis situations like shutoff notices.



ELIGIBILITY DETAILS

Do you qualify?

Full requirements for this program.

Income limits by household size

HOUSEHOLD SIZE	MONTHLY INCOME LIMIT
1 person	\$1,995/mo
2 people	\$2,705/mo
3 people	\$3,415/mo
4 people	\$4,125/mo
5 people	\$4,835/mo

6 people

\$5,545/mo

150% of the Federal Poverty Level

OTHER REQUIREMENTS

- Texas resident with proof (utility bill, lease)
- U.S. citizen or qualified non-citizen (lawful permanent resident, refugee)
- Automatic eligibility if receiving SNAP, SSI, TANF, or certain veterans' benefits

APPLICATION PROCESS

How to apply

To apply, call the TDHCA
at 1-877-399-8939

(weekdays, 8 a.m. – 5
p.m.) or dial 2-1-1 to find
your local agency. Note
that waitlists and
processing times vary by
county.

- ① If you have an online account with your utility company (like Texas Gas Service), set it up before applying, it speeds up the documentation process.

DOCUMENTS YOU'LL NEED

0/9



- ☐ Valid government-issued photo ID (Texas

driver's license,
passport, or state ID)

- ☐ Proof of citizenship or legal residency status for all household members
- ☐ Proof of income from last 30 days (pay stubs, Social Security award letter, pension statements)

[Show all 9 documents](#)

GOOD TO KNOW

- Households facing a life-threatening energy crisis (such as a broken AC in extreme heat or an immediate shutoff) may receive expedited processing within 48 hours, even when standard waitlists are long.
- Household size includes everyone living at the address who shares utility bills, not just family members
- Benefits are paid directly to your utility company. you

won't receive a check or cash payment

- Funding runs out quickly each year, so apply as early as possible when applications open

STEPS TO APPLY

1

Find your local agency

Call 2-1-1 or (877) 399-8939 to locate your Community Action Agency or CEAP provider. You can also

provider. You can also search at 211Texas.org.

2

Gather required documents

Collect proof of income, identification, recent utility bills in the applicant's name, and proof of Texas residency before contacting the agency.

3

Submit application

Apply by phone, online, mail, or in-person

man, or in person
through your local CAA.
Each agency has
different application
methods and forms.

4

Wait for caseworker contact

You'll be placed on a waitlist. A caseworker will call when your turn arrives and funding is available for your area.



PROCESSING TIME



Varies by region;
placed on waitlist
after submission,
caseworker calls
when turn arrives



WAITLIST

Yes, common;
applications placed
in line by site,
funding-dependent

**Find Local CEAP
Agency**



Official CEAP Information



GET IN TOUCH

Texas 2-1-1

Free statewide helpline
to find your local CEAP
agency

 **2-1-1**

24 hours, 7 days a
week

LIHEAP National Helpline

Federal helpline for
energy assistance
programs

 **(877) 399-8939**

Monday–Friday, 8:00
AM–6:00 PM CT

Travis County CEAP

Example local agency
serving Austin area

 **(512) 584-4120**

Mon-Fri 8am-5pm CT



[Visit official program
page](#)

RELATED PROGRAMS

Weatherization Assistance
Program (WAP)

SNAP Food Benefits

Medicaid

THINGS TO KNOW

COMMON QUESTIONS

How long is the waitlist
really?



Can I apply on behalf of my elderly loved one? 

What if my loved one's income is slightly over the limit? 

Can my loved one get LIHEAP and apply for other energy programs at the same time? 

What happens if my loved one moves to a different county after applying? 

applying.

Does the program cover propane or only electric and gas? 

What if my loved one rents and utilities are included in rent? 

How often can my loved one receive LIHEAP benefits? 

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Dallas, TX



Los Angeles, CA

Chicago, IL

San Antonio, TX

Atlanta, GA

Denver, CO

Phoenix, AZ

New York, NY

Miami, FL

Philadelphia, PA

Seattle, WA

BROWSE BY STATE

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California

Florida

New York

Pennsylvania

Illinois

Ohio

Georgia

North Carolina

Arizona

Michigan

Virginia

BY CARE TYPE

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Memory Care

Home Health
Care

Nursing Homes

Independent
Living



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